

birds, rabbits and antelopes occasionally, they do so mostly because they do not have means to earn a livelihood or are egged on to do so by influential people. Our pain at the loss of wild animals cannot give us the liberty of making harsh statements about the community. They have as much right to dignity as any one of us.

ARCHANA SHARMA,
Aranya, Bhopal

OUR CORRESPONDENT REPLIES

The report did not say the entire community hunts tigers. It stated that those who hunt them, as part of organised gangs, are mostly Pardhis or Bawariyas. I do not believe that they are forced to indulge in hunting as they do it in a cohesive group with great craft. My report is about people who kill tigers for money to feed multi-million dollar international trade in tiger parts that has a thriving market in China.

Question Mark

Your story on the prime minister's press conference has faulted Dr Manmohan Singh for failing to give satisfactory answers ("Prime Time Flop Show", June 7). To give the devil his due, here is a prime minister who is hemmed in from all sides. If he has to kowtow to party president Sonia Gandhi, he also has to humour his allies. Had he

been running a one-party government, he'd have been more articulate for he is one of the few Congressmen who has the integrity to persevere in the interests of the people. C.V. ARAVIND,
via www.indiatoday.in

Home Run

Human Resource Development Minister Kapil Sibal is trying to revamp our education system, but I doubt if he will be able to do much ("The De-School Brigade", May 24). I have homeschooled my kids. My son, 17, has been teaching



“The Mangalore tragedy is a wake-up call for the aviation ministry (“Skirting the Edge”, June 7). Instead of pointing fingers at pilots, the authorities should introspect and take corrective steps.”

D. VINOD, Ahmedabad

English for the last five years, while my daughter, 14, is on her way to become a beautician and an English teacher. I've taught them the most important aspect of education: earning money and living well. A HOMESCHOOLED PROFESSOR OF ENGLISH

Testing Times

A lot was expected from BJP chief Nitin Gadkari but the way he has landed himself into controversies, it is certain that he is not on right track ("Slippery Slope", June 7). He must have realised that he will have to do something extraordinary to bring the BJP back into the counting. BAL GOVIND, Noida

Quality Makeover

Ill-equipped faculties are largely responsible for the poor performance of some universities and colleges ("A Chunk of Change", May

31). The National Commission for Higher Education and Research must lay down norms for recruitment for private universities and colleges and cancel appointments made in violation of the norms. SAHANA RAYAN,
via www.indiatoday.in

30
YEARS
AGO IN
INDIA
TODAY

AUGUST 16-31, 1980

Preparing for a Split

Akali politics is like the soil of Punjab—fertile and productive. The only difference is that while the soil gives an abundance of food, the Akalis generate a maximum of feuds. Last fortnight, when two warring factions in the Punjab-based party, expelled each other, the foundations were laid for a second vertical split in the Akali Dal's 26-year-history. The leaders of the party's two factions, former Punjab chief minister Parkash Singh Badal and Akali Dal chief Jagdev Singh Talwandi, know that the party stands a good chance of wresting power from the Congress (I) which has a wafer-thin majority in the 117-member state assembly. Though the struggle for gaining control over the Dal among the two factions has been going on for the last 10 months, it took a serious turn on August 9, when a seven-member committee appointed by the priests expelled Talwandi for six years for his alleged connivance with the Congress (I) government in toppling the Akali Dal ministry last February. **by Prabhu Chawla**



TALWANDI

Readers are recommended to make appropriate enquiries before sending money, incurring expenses or entering into commitments in relation to any advertisement appearing in this publication. The India Today Group does not vouch for any claims made by the advertisers of products and services. The printer, publisher, editor-in-chief and the editor of the India Today Group publications shall not be held liable for any consequences in the event of such claims not being honoured by the advertisers.

E-MAIL YOUR LETTERS TO: letters.editor@intoday.com

FAX THEM TO: 011-23316180

OR LOG ON TO: www.indiatoday.in